someone compares and condemns Indian philosophical and religious literature from the standpoint of Christian revelation alone, something to be ruled out at the very beginning. And yet, this is exactly what Zaehner has done in this book.

Let us have a look at the book. It contains five chapters: 1. Comparative Religion; 2 and 3. The Indian Contribution; 4. Prophets Outside Israel; 5. Consumatum Est; and an Appendix on the *Qur'ān* and the Christ.

From the beginning to the end, the book is full of fallacious and palpably absurd statements about Indian religions. It would require a much longer article to contradict him completely—or even adequately. Let me therefore confine myself within the space and will at my disposal, to the minimum of Hinduism alone, without paying any attention to what he says about Christianity, Buddhism, Islam, Zoroastrianism, and other religions. As will be seen from the Table of Contents, two of the five chapters which have been examined very carefully for this review deal with the Indian religions, Hinduism and Buddhism.

The author says that after lecturing on Christianity he took this opportunity "for coming to grips with the problem of how a Christian should regard the non-Christian religions... and to show how the main trends in Hinduism and Buddhism... meet and complete each other in the Christian revelation" (p. ix). He then sets the main theme of the book in showing that the "immanentist religions of India... do not contradict any essential Christian doctrine, and that their representations of incarnate God, incomplete though they are, are valid prefigurations of the God incarnate in Christ" (p. ix). Later, he states "Unless I am greatly mistaken, all the strands we have been trying to bring together in the different religions, meet *only* in *one* place, and that is the religion of Jesus Christ. In the person of Christ the two contradictions meet and are reconciled" (p. 180).[2] He ends: "My thesis is this, that Jesus Christ fulfills not only the law and the prophets of Israel but also the Prophet of Iran and the sages of India" (p. 184).

Zaehner is most welcome to all the merits of Christianity and all that the religion of Jesus Christ accomplishes. There is no quarrel with him on that. In fact, a Hindu should be the first to acknowledge the good that there is, not only in Christianity, but in all the religions of the world. Trouble starts when he misbrands Hinduism as an "immanentist" religion, or when he says that Hinduism and Buddhism "meet and complete each other in the Christian revelation," or that they "do not contradict any essential Christian doctrine," or that the Hindu incarnations of God "are valid pre-